Abdullah Al Zahid

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Talent Acquisition
Advisory
Mott MacDonald, Toronto, ON

Re: Senior Advisory Consultant, Operational Readiness

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Senior Advisory Consultant, Operational Readiness position. I worked at Mott MacDonald briefly in early 2023 before joining Metrolinx in Service Design, and I am now an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto. Operational readiness is about knowing what a change will do to an operation before it reaches service, and that has been the thread of my work.

At Metrolinx I ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, reliability and recovery before they were taken forward, and assessed the service effect of temporary and permanent slow orders. I worked with schedulers, operations staff and engineers on service design decisions and presented the evidence behind them. I also set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

At Mott MacDonald I ran Synchro traffic simulations of Ontario Line construction staging and road closures. At the City I built the Transportation Data Dashboard, which brought several years of survey data into one validated source the division reports from, and I write the briefing notes and presentations that carry findings to managers in other divisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps, which are significant at this level. The posting asks for ten years on major infrastructure programs; I have about four and a half. I have not led operational readiness, activation or transition work, handover and acceptance, change management or operational trials, and I have not led commercial management, business development or junior staff. If the practice has a role closer to my level in operational readiness, I would welcome being considered for it.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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